

Alexander W. Bartik

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Academic Appointments

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign,
Assistant Professor of Economics, July 2017 to present

Education

Ph.D., Massachusetts Institute of Technology, 2017
B.A. in Ethics, Politics, and Economics, *cum laude* with distinction in the major, Yale College, 2008

Other Affiliations

Principal Investigator, Open Research Unconditional Income Study (ORUS), 2018 to present
Research Affiliate, Inclusive Economy Lab of the University of Chicago, 2018 to present
Affiliated Professor, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab, 2025 to present

Fields of Interest

Labor Economics, Public Finance, Urban Economics

Published and Accepted Papers

“Does Income Affect Health? Evidence from a Randomized Controlled Trial of a Guaranteed Income” with Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, David E. Broockman, Patrick K. Krause, and Eva Vivalt, January 2026.

Conditionally Accepted, American Economic Review

“The Employment Effects of a Guaranteed Income: Experimental Evidence from Two U.S. States” with Eva Vivalt, Elizabeth Rhodes, David E. Broockman, Patrick K. Krause, and Sarah Miller.

Forthcoming, Quarterly Journal of Economics

“When should public programs be privately administered? Theory and evidence from the Paycheck Protection Program” with Zoe Cullen, Edward Glaeser, Michael Luca, Christopher Stanton, and Adi Sunderam

Forthcoming, Review of Economics and Statistics

“Black Suburbanization: Causes and Consequences of a Transformation of American Cities” with Evan Mast

Forthcoming, Review of Economics and Statistics

"Deleting a Signal: Evidence from Pre-Employment Credit Checks" with Scott Nelson,
Review of Economics and Statistics January 2025, Volume 107, Issue 1, pp 152–171

"The Rise of Remote Work: Evidence on Productivity and Preferences From Firm and Worker Surveys"
with Zoe Cullen, Edward Glaeser, Michael Luca, and Christopher Stanton
Journal of Economics and Management Strategy Fall 2025, Volume 34, Issue 3, pp 759–772

"The Impact of COVID-19 on small business outcomes and expectations" with Marianne Bertrand, Zoe Cullen, Edward Glaeser, Michael Luca, and Christopher Stanton
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences June 2020, Volume 117, Issue 30.

"Measuring the Labor Market at the Onset of the COVID-19 Crisis: Evidence from Traditional and Non-Traditional Data" (with Marianne Bertrand, Feng Li, Jesse Rothstein, and Matt Unrath)
Brookings Papers on Economic Activity (Summer 2020)

"The Local Economic and Welfare Consequences of Hydraulic Fracturing" with Janet Currie, Michael Greenstone, and Chris Knittel
American Economic Journal: Applied Economics October 2019, Volume 11, Number 4, pp 105–155

Working Papers

"Income Shocks and Intrahousehold Dynamics: Evidence from a Guaranteed Income Experiment" with Elizabeth Rhodes, David Broockman, Eva Vivalt, Patrick K. Krause, and Sarah Miller, August 2026

"The Costs of Housing Regulation: Evidence From Generative Regulatory Measurement" with Arpit Gupta and Dan Milo, December 2025

"The Impact of Unconditional Cash Transfers on Parenting and Children" with Patrick K. Krause, Elizabeth Rhodes, Sarah Miller, David E. Broockman, Eva Vivalt, July 2025
Reject and Resubmit at American Economic Review

"The Impact of Unconditional Cash Transfers on Consumption and Household Balance Sheets: Experimental Evidence from Two U.S. States" with Elizabeth Rhodes, David E. Broockman, Patrick K. Krause, Sarah Miller, and Eva Vivalt, July 2025

"The Causal Effects of Income on Political Attitudes and Behavior: A Randomized Field Experiment" with David E. Broockman, Elizabeth Rhodes, Karina Dotson, Sarah Miller, Patrick K. Krause and Eva Vivalt, December 2024

"Moving Costs and Worker Adjustment to Changes in Labor Demand: Evidence from Longitudinal Census Data", October 2018

Works in Progress

"What Have We Learned from Randomized Controlled Trials of Guaranteed Income?" with Eva Vivalt, Andrew Goodman-Bacon, Sarah Miller, and Elizabeth Rhodes, January 2026
Revise and Resubmit at the Journal of Economic Literature

"Imperfect Information and the Occupational Transitions of Lower Wage Workers" with Bryan Stuart and Seth Chizeck

"Minority Under-Representation in Apprenticeships: Demand and Supply-Side Explanations" with Marianne Bertrand and Bryan Stuart

"The Causal Effect of Zoning" with Arpit Gupta, Daniel Milo, and Luofeng Zhou

"The Origins of American Zoning" with Arpit Gupta, Daniel Milo, and Desmond O'Shaughnessy

"The Effects of Unconditional Cash Transfers: Experimental Evidence from Two Large Pilots" with Nour Abdul-Razzak, Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt

Non-Peer Reviewed Papers

"Search and Matching in Modern Labor Markets: A Landscape Report" with Bryan A. Stuart, July 2022

(*Urban Institute WorkRise Research Report*)

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Excellence in Teaching a Field Course: Illinois Economics Graduate Student Organization (2022-23)

Excellence in Refereeing Awards: AER (2018), AER: Insights (2020, 2021)

UIUC List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by their Students, Fall 2017, Fall 2018, Fall 2020, Fall 2022, Fall 2023

Lincoln Institute for Land Policy Dissertation Fellowship, 2015-16

MIT Graduate Student Fellowship, 2011-13

Wrexham-Heinz Prize for the Best Senior Thesis in the Social Sciences, Yale College, 2008

Research Funding

Arnold Foundation for "Scaling Direct Municipal Outreach to Measure the Causal Effects of Zoning Reforms," 2026-2028 (with Arpit Gupta, Dan Milo, Desmond O'Shaughnessy, and Luofeng Zhou): \$185,900

Campus Research Board for "The Historical Origins, Development, and Effects of Zoning Regulations: Evidence from the United States", 2026-27 (with Arpit Gupta and Daniel Milo): \$29,472

Coefficient Giving for "Understanding Housing Production: Causal Evidence and Public Data on Municipal Zoning", 2025-26 (with Arpit Gupta and Daniel Milo): \$135,000

National Institutes of Health for "Experimental Evidence on the Relationship Between Income and Health", 2023-28 (with Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$2,311,645

Emergent Ventures for "The Costs of Housing Regulation: Evidence from Generative Regulatory Measurement", 2024-25 (with Arpit Gupta): \$50,000

Russell Sage Foundation for "Allegheny County Job Seekers Study", 2023-25 (with Bryan Stuart): \$50,000

Urban Institute for "Minority Under-Representation in Apprenticeships: Demand and Supply-Side Explanations", 2022-24 (with Marianne Bertrand and Bryan Stuart): \$262,403

National Institutes of Health for "Experimental Evidence on the Impact of Parental Income on Child Health and Well-Being", 2021-26 (with Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$2,494,318

National Science Foundation for “The Impact of Sustained Unconditional Cash Transfers on Labor Market Outcomes”, 2021-24 (with Marianne Bertrand, Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$549,136

Spencer Foundation’s Large Research Grants on Education Program for “The Effects of Unconditional Cash Transfers on Educational Outcomes”, 2021-27 (with Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$374,947

UIUC Campus Research Board for “The Geography of Jobs”, 2020-23 (with Eliza Forsythe): \$21,637

J-PAL North America for “The Impact of Unconditional Cash Transfers on Consumption in the United States”, 2020-23 (with David Broockman, Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$250,155

Russell Sage Foundation for “The Impact of COVID-19 on Low-Income Individuals and Families”, 2020-21 (with David Broockman, Sarah Miller, Elizabeth Rhodes, and Eva Vivalt): \$50,000

Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation for “An Experiment to Explore the Impact of Customized Job Recommendations”, 2020-26 (with Bryan Stuart): \$142,176

J-PAL North America (J-PAL NA): Work of the Future Grant for “Experimental Evidence on a Low-Cost Job Search Tool”, 2018-25 (with Bryan Stuart): \$49,359

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Research Initiative in Labor Markets Research Grant, 2018-2019 (with Bryan Stuart): \$27,000

J-PAL North America (J-PAL NA) Travel Grant, 2017-18 (with Elizabeth Setren): \$5,000

Washington Center for Equitable Growth Doctoral Grant, 2016-17: \$15,000

Professional Activities

Presentations (includes scheduled)

2026: Indiana University Public Finance Working Group Workshop, Society of Labor Economists, NBER Summer Institute (Children)

2025: University of Kentucky, Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation, Chicago Fed Urban Workshop, American Finance Association meeting at ASSA, Triangle Applied Microeconomics Conference at Duke University, University of Illinois Institute for Government and Policy Affairs, NBER Fall Meetings (Household Finance), Chicago Booth Machine Learning and Economics Summer Conference, New York City Independent Budget Office

2024: University of California-Berkeley, University of Chicago-Harris, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis Conference, Department of Housing and Urban Development, Booth Household Finance Conference, AirBnB

2022: SOLE, Mid-Midwest Applied Micro Conference at Purdue

2021: WEAI International Meeting, LERA, AEI, WEAI, NBER Summer Institute (Public), United States Military Academy (West Point)

2020: University of Chicago: Demography Seminar, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta Conference

2019: University of Illinois at Chicago, Society of Labor Economists, Summer Institute on Theoretical Economics (SITE) at Stanford University

2018: Michigan State University, University of California Berkeley-Haas

2017: Columbia University-SIPA, University of Illinois-Urbana-Champaign, University of Maryland, University of California-Santa Cruz, Urban Institute, Office of Tax Analysis, Congressional Budget Office, Abt Associates

2016: U.S. Census Bureau, University of California, Berkeley: Energy Camp, MIT Labor Lunch

2014: NBER Summer Institute (Real Estate)

Discussions

"Dynamic Effects of Co-Racial Hiring" by C. Miller and I. Schmutte, *ASSA Annual Meeting*, January 2023.

"Know Thyself: Access to Own Credit Report and the Retail Mortgage Market" by A. Kumar, *Midwest Finance Association Conference*, March 2022.

"Working Remotely? Selection, Treatment, and the Market for Remote Work" by N. Emanuel and E. Harrington. *AREUEA/ASSA Annual Meeting*, January 2022.

"Did the Paycheck Protection Program Help Small Businesses? Evidence from Commercial Mortgage-backed Securities" by S. Agrawal, B. Ambrose, L. Lopez, and X. Xiao. *American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association*, May 2021.

"The Signaling Role of Parental Leave" by L. To. *Western Economic Association International*, March 2021.

"Tax Refund Uncertainty: Evidence and Welfare Implications", by S. Caldwell, S. Nelson, and D. Waldinger, and "Welfare Cuts and Well-Being: Evidence from Indiana in the Great Recession", by D. Wu. *Washington Center for Equitable Growth*, December 2020.

Referee Service

American Economic Review, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Journal of Health Economics*, *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Economic Development Quarterly*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, *Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Monetary Economics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Industrial and Labor Relations Review*, *Labour Economics*, *Management Science*, *National Tax Journal*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Quarterly Review of Economics and Finance*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Financial Studies*

Conference Service

Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) 2021 Conference Program Committee, *SOLE / EALE / AASLE 2025 World Congress of Labor Economics Program Committee*, *SOLE Prize Committee for Contributions to Data & Measurement 2025*, *SOLE 2027 Conference Program Committee*

Grant Referee Service

Abdul-Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab, *Smith Richardson Foundation*, *Russell Sage Foundation*, *UIUC Campus Research Board*, *National Institutes of Health Review Board*

Departmental Service

Departmental Advisory Board (2020-present)
Applied Micro Research Lunch Co-Coordinator (2025-present)
Young Applied Micro Faculty Research Lunch Coordinator (2022-present)
Hiring Committee (2017-18, 2021-22)
Resek Conference Co-organizer (2019, 2023, 2027)
PhD Student Labor Research Group (Spring 2022- Spring 2023)
Economics Graduate Student Organization, Faculty Co-Advisor, 2020-2021

Advising

Dissertation Committees

Julian Oolman (2026, First placement: Sandia National Laboratories, Data Scientist)
David Buller (2026, First placement: Haverford College, Visiting Assistant Professor)
Keitaro Ninomiya (2026, First placement: University of Tokyo, Postdoctoral Researcher)
Sunny Liu (2026, First placement: Charles River Associates, Senior Associate)
Cristhian Molina (2026, First placement: Northwestern University School of Education and Social Policy, Postdoctoral Researcher)
Yoonwhan Kim (2026, First placement: Korea Development Institute, Associate Fellow)
Sanghee Mun (2026, First placement: Bank of Korea, Economist)
Callan Whamond (2026, First placement: Freddie Mac, Senior Quantitative Analyst)
Alok Ranjan (2025, First placement: Plaksha University, Assistant Professor)
Wilfried Adohinzin (2025, First placement: Charles River Associates, Senior Associate)
Abby Stocker (2025, First placement: William and Mary, Assistant Professor)
Yiqiu Liu (2025, First placement: Meta, Data Scientist)
Youngwook Jung (2024, First placement: Korea Development Institute, Associate Fellow)
Sarah Kim (2024, First placement: Stanford University, Postdoctoral Researcher in Health Policy)
Melany Gualavisi (2023, First placement: Amazon, Economist)
Heejin Kim (2023, First placement: Michigan State University, Postdoctoral Researcher)
Noelia Romero (2023, First placement: Universidad de San Andres, Lecturer)
Felipe Diaz Klaassen (2023, First placement: Allegheny County Department of Human Services, Data Scientist)
Guilherme Amorim (2023, First placement: UIUC Gies, Postdoctoral Researcher)
Mateo Arbelaez (2023, Chair, First placement: Wayfair, Economist)

Marcelino Batista Guerra (2023, First placement: Amazon, Economist)
 Daniel Rodrigues Silva Tabak (2023, First placement: Amazon, Economist)
 Tatiana Mocanu (2022, First placement: Columbia University, Assistant Professor)
 Anahid Bauer (2022, First placement: Institut Mines-Telecom Business School, Assistant Professor)
 Lucas Squarize Chagas (2022, First placement: Meta, Data Scientist)
 Mariya Shappo (2021, First placement: Uber Technologies, Economist)
 Asad Khan (2020, First placement: University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Business, Postdoctoral Researcher)
 Nazanin Khazra (2020, First placement: University of Toronto, Teaching Assistant Professor)
 Hee-yeon Cho (2020, First placement: Korea Institute of Public Finance, Associate Fellow)
 Sofia Fernandez Guerrico (2020, First placement: Solvay Brussels School of Economics and Management, Postdoctoral Researcher)
 Juan Munoz Morales (2020, First placement: IESEG School of Management, Assistant Professor)

Current advisees with scheduled or completed preliminary defense

Lovepreet Singh
 Ke Gao
 Shivangi Ambardar

Third-Year Paper Advising

Rebecca Moore (2026-27)
 Efthymios Sintos (2025-26)
 Rong Yuwen (2024-25)
 Guilherme Amorim (2019-20)

Teaching

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Econ 590/523: MSPE (Masters) Applied Econometrics: Topics in Program Evaluation and Policy Analysis, Fall 2017, Fall 2018, Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Fall 2023, Fall 2025, Fall 2026
 Econ 590/541: Graduate Labor Economics, Fall 2018, Fall 2020, Fall 2022, Fall 2026
 Econ 491: Decisionmaking, Spring 2019, Fall 2023, Spring 2025, Fall 2025
 Econ 490: Applied Econometrics: Program Evaluation and Policy Analysis, Fall 2017

Past Positions

Research Assistant at The Hamilton Project, Brookings Institution, 2010- 2011
 Project Associate at Innovations for Poverty Action, 2008-2010.

Other Information

Citizenship: United States

Last updated: September 28, 2026